

Session 10: Phrasal Verbs & Dependent Prepositions

1. Two-Part Phrasal Verbs

Verbs can combine with 'particles' (adverbs or prepositions) to make phrasal verbs. While some are really informal (eg. *call off*, or *shut up*), most can be used in your academic writing. They often have more formal synonyms:

Phrasal Verb	Synonym
account for	explain
bring about	discover
carry on	continue
cut down on	reduce
find out	discover
get across	communicate
hold out for	wait

Phrasal Verb	Synonym
leave out	omit
look into	research / examine
pass on	transmit
pick up	resume/start
point out	highlight
set up	arrange
use up	exhaust

Although some phrasal verbs have an exact one-word equivalent (eg. *leave out* = *omit*), others do not (eg. *to look up a word* = *to seek the meaning of a word in a reference source*).

Task 1: Here are 10 of the most common phrasal verbs that you could use in your writing. In your breakout rooms, decide which is the best option.

1. In her latest article, Kaufmann (2020) a theory which is likely to prove controversial.

- a) puts forward
- b) makes up
- c) goes into

2. A series of experiments was between June and July of 2012.

- a) worked on
- b) carried out

- c) set out

3. Children under the age of 15 nearly half of Rwanda's population.

- a) set up
- b) make up
- c) make out

4. Greene (2018) that the increase in life expectancy has led to many intractable economic problems.

- a) points out
- b) points to
- c) points at

5. In her article, Losanov (2017) prove that wage depression is mainly the result of a continuing mechanisation of labour.

- a) sets out to
- b) makes out to
- c) points out to

6. Granze (2019) industrial agriculture as the leading cause of climate change in this decade.

- a) points at
- b) points on
- c) points to

7. The contract, arguably, did not the terms and conditions adequately.

- a) thinking on
- b) set out
- c) make out

8. Countries wishing to remain in the European Union must the principle of free movement of people.

- a) adhere to
- b) hang on to
- c) make out

9. The theory, originally developed to help explain animal behaviour, has also been decisions made by traders.

- a) affixed to
- b) adhered to
- c) applied to

10. Something is wrong. The finance and accounting departments need to their calculations carefully.

- a) go over
- b) go with
- c) go after

2. Three-Part Phrasal Verbs

Task 2: Some of the hardest phrasal verbs have two prepositions. Below are some of the most common ones that you can use – can you match them to the meanings?

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|--------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1. catch up with | a) encounter difficulties |
| 2. catch up on | b) reduce |
| 3. come up against | c) give attention to |
| 4. come up with | d) reluctantly agree |
| 5. cut back on | e) be aware of |
| 6. face up to | f) think of a new idea |
| 7. get down to | g) reach a higher standard |
| 8. get out of | h) finish the supply |
| 9. go along with | i) as good as expected |
| 10. live up to | j) deal with a difficult situation |
| 11. run out of | k) leave, escape from, avoid doing |
| 12. watch out for | l) to bring yourself up to date |

Task 3: Complete these sentences, using three of the words in brackets:

1. Soros argues that the USA must _____ (come/up/to/of/face) the dangers of the global market in derivatives.
2. With these reforms, the government is likely to _____ (with/against/up/go/come) considerable public criticism.
3. There is a limit to the regular expenses that a small business can _____ (on/get/cut/of/back) in a recession.
4. A national helpline has been set up to help people to _____ (out/along/get/go/of) debt.
5. The Pacific island nation of Tuvalu runs the constant risk of _____ (coming/out/up/of/running) drinking water.
6. Brand agencies can help companies to _____ (up/get/down/with/come) a name for a new product or service.

3. Passive Phrasal Verbs

The below verbs are most often used as passives (*be* + past participle + preposition). These can be very useful additions to your work:

Passive Phrasal Verb	Passive Phrasal Verb
be aimed at	be involved in
be associated with	be known as
be based on	be prejudiced against
be considered/regarded/seen as	be required for
be defined as	be used in
be derived from	be involved in
be divided into	be known as

4. Dependent Prepositions

Dependent prepositions can follow nouns or verbs. Sometimes there is a logic to which preposition is used, but often there is not, so familiarity is the key to using these correctly!

Task 4: Add the correct preposition to the following sentences:

1. I am writing with respect ____ your letter of 30th June 2010.
2. I signed a petition in support ____ the campaign to end the marketing of baby milk in developing countries.
3. Organizational ability is an essential attribute ____ a good manager.
4. I wouldn't dream of attributing such a lack of judgment ____ you.
5. There is a team of writers working in conjunction ____ each other on the book.
6. He managed to convince the jury ____ his innocence.
7. I like all kinds of food with the exception ____ English food.
8. The company is concentrating its resources ____ developing new products.
9. At this point in the speech, the minister departed ____ his prepared text.

10. The English word 'olive' is derived from the Latin word 'oliva'.
Most people associate this brand ____ good quality.
11. The new salary scale only refers ____ company managers and directors.
12. We're looking at the feasibility ____ building a new shopping centre there.
13. There's a clear distinction ____ the dialects spoken in the two regions.
14. People with asthma have difficulty ____ breathing.
15. The hospital is making approaches ____ local businesses in their bid to raise money.
16. I think we should put as much emphasis ____ preventing disease as we do on curing it.
17. The machine works according to the principle ____ electromagnetic conduction.
18. The reason ____ the accident was engine failure, not human error.
19. The number of new cases ____ the illness appears to be declining.